



Referral Network for Independent Professionals

Referna matches independent professionals (fractional execs, AI consultants, GEO specialists, and more) into referral circles where trusted peers refer clients to each other.

Pre-Seed Round

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

BASICS

Problem	Independent professionals' #1 problem is getting the next client.	CUSTOMER →
Solution	Referna matches them into circles of trusted peers who refer clients to each other.	SOLUTION →

EVIDENCE

Will they refer each other?	340K members of an offline network (BNI) pay \$800/yr to refer \$26.4B/yr — for 40 years.	INCUMBENT →
Can we get users?	134 registered, 77 weekly active — doubling every 2 weeks, six weeks post-launch.	TRACTION →

SIZE

Are there many customers?	130M independent professionals globally; 9.26M addressable in the US.	MARKET →
Will it have a moat?	Networks have great moats — and grow fast once seeded.	OPPORTUNITY →

TIMING

Why now	AI is approaching the inflection point where it can facilitate the circles BNI needs 40,000 operators to run.	WHY NOW →
Why us?	We love networks — built 3 already. 2 exits. 2nd startup together.	TEAM →

CUSTOMER

Meet Ami, an independent professional

**Ami B.**

Agentic Marketing Consultant · sells to early-stage · self employed

HERZLIYA · REAL · REACHABLE FOR REFERENCE

\$150K

2025 REVENUE

HIS #1 PROBLEM

Getting the next client.

"That's my #1 problem — isn't it everyone's top one?"

Ami B. · April 2026

***24 of 26** independent professionals interviewed
agreed with Ami.*

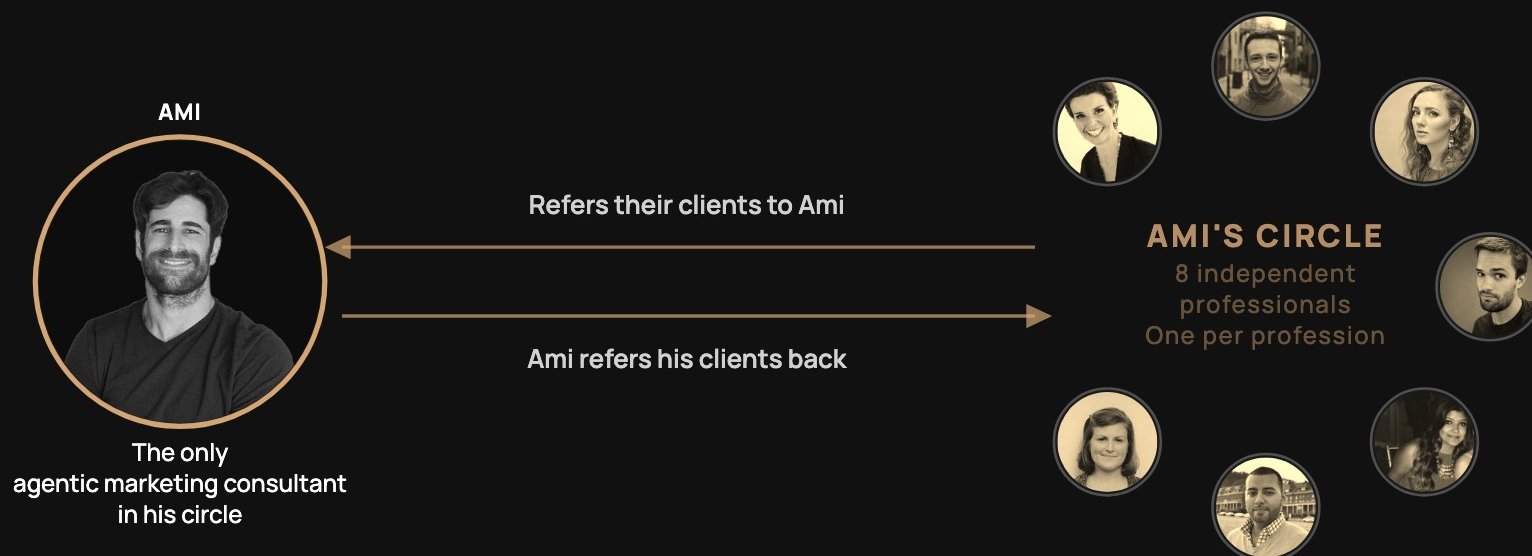
Referna interviews · April 2026

→ For independent professionals like Ami - **getting the next client is the top problem.**

Source: Ami B. interview (Apr 2026)

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Ami joins a circle of trusted peers who refer clients to each other.



Each referral builds more trust in the circle — that's the flywheel.

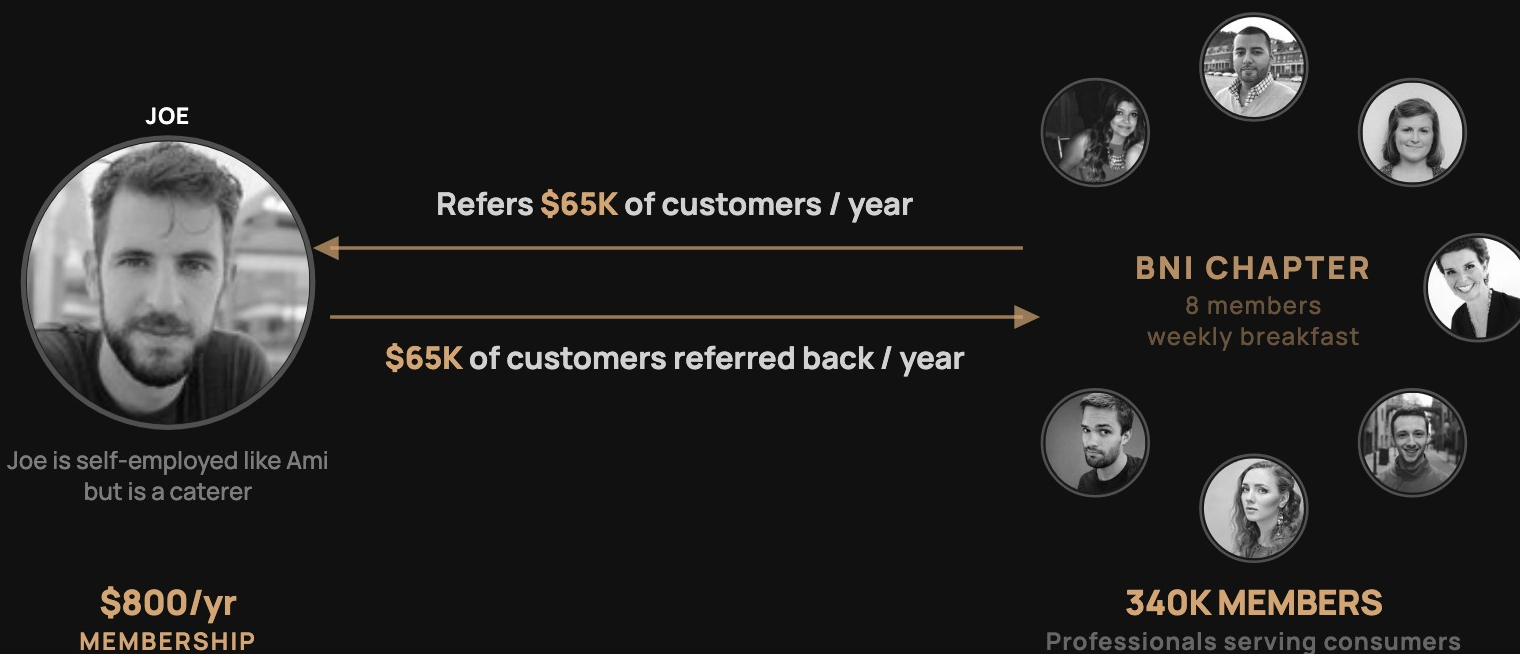
→ For Ami — **circles solve the next-client problem.** He just needs to find his circle.

Sources: Referna interviews · BNI Mid-Year Report 2025

INCUMBENT

BNI: Referral network — \$26.4B referrals/year

Referna and BNI have the same concept — trusted peers refer clients



→ BNI proved **the model and market** but its legacy methods are limiting growth

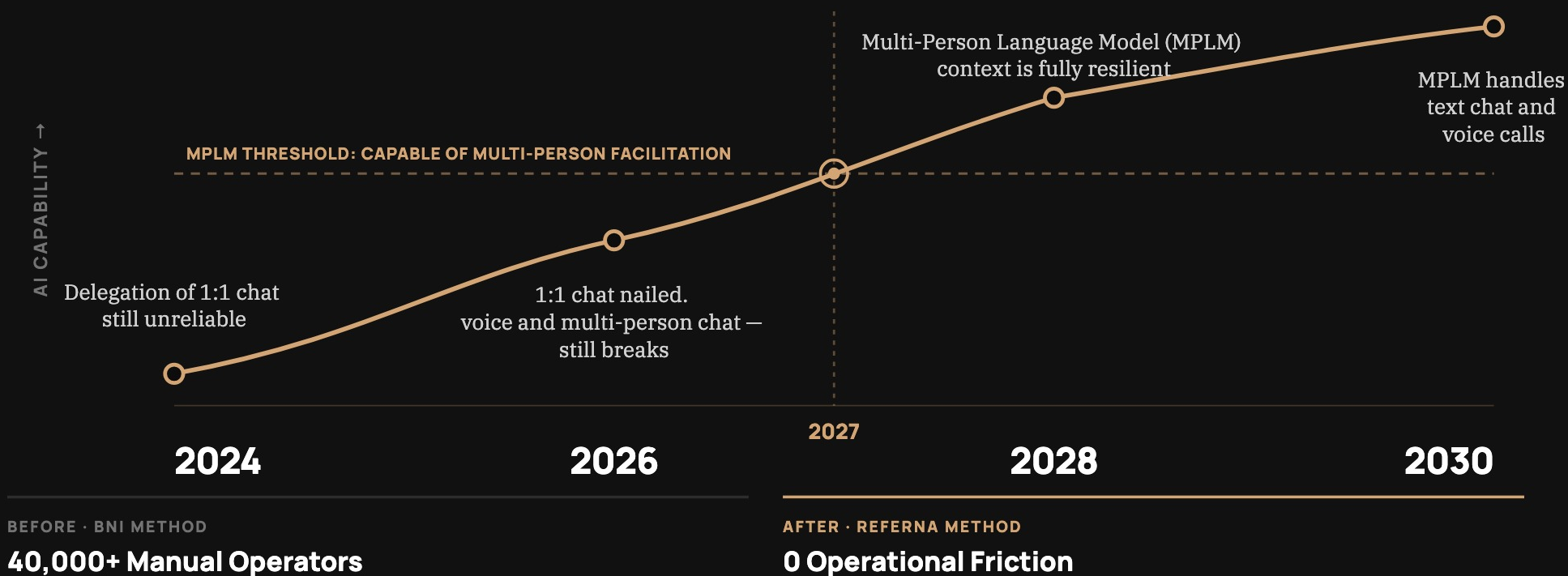
Sources: BNI Mid-Year Report 2025; bni.com; BNI US membership fees (\$575–\$849/yr, 1-year participation)

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WHY NOW

MPLMs Defeat the Franchise Model

Replacing a legacy army of 40,000+ manual operators (BNI method) with the infinite software scale of **Multi-Person Language Models (MPLMs)**.



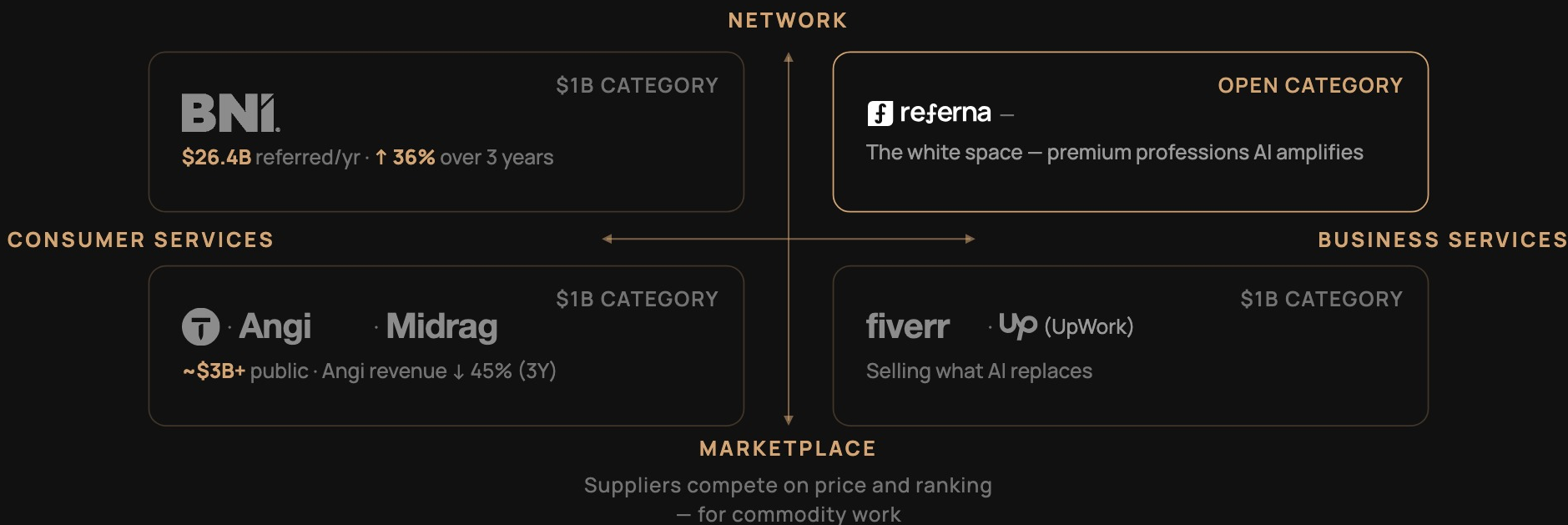
→ MPLMs shift a legacy franchise model into a **high-margin, venture-scale network**.

Sources: Referna analysis · multi-person context-window trajectory · BNI operational structure

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CATEGORY

What Referna is — and isn't



YPO = peer development for CEOs — different audience, not a referral network.

LinkedIn = different beast — professional graph monetized by ads and recruiters, not a lead source for independent professionals.

→ Each category is a billion-dollar business. The missing quadrant is ours.

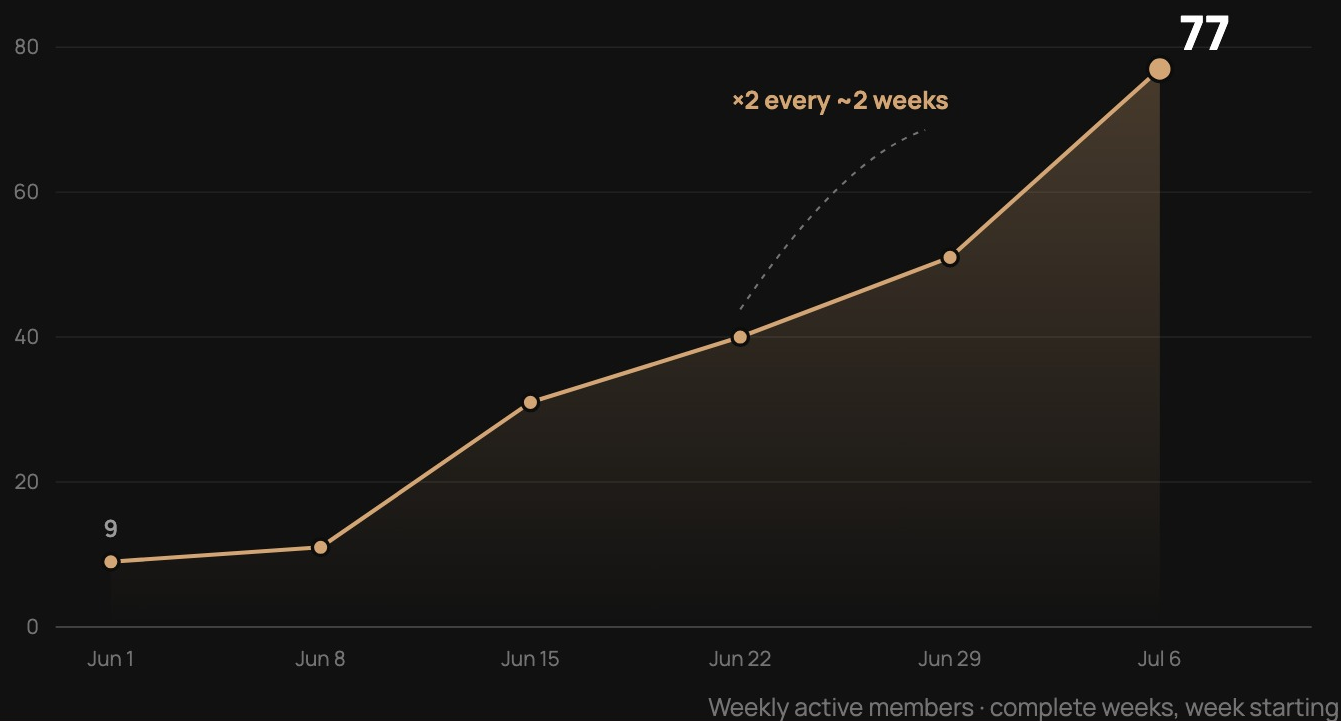
Sources: BNI Mid-Year Report 2025 · public filings (Fiverr, Upwork, Angi) · Thumbtack last private round

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TRACTION

Doubling every two weeks.

Weekly active members since the June 1 launch — invitation-led.

**77**

weekly active members last week

134

registered in the first 6 weeks

×8.5

WAU growth since launch week

→ **How it started: a smoke test at 20× benchmark.** **How it's going: ×8.5 in six weeks.**

Sources: Referna growth dashboard (Jul 13, 2026) · smoke test: 139 cold emails, 30.2% replies, May 2026

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DISTRIBUTION

The 30.2% wasn't the only test.

We ran weekly tests — focused on cracking distribution before building product.

N=134

Weekly growth

50%+

W/W USER GROWTH

77

WAU LAST WEEK

7× YC's "good" threshold (5–7%).

134 registered in first 6 weeks.

N=139 VS 5,201 CONTROL

Cold email → onboarded

6.7%

OF EMAILS REACH ONBOARDED

Cold outreach converts.

N=14

Virality

3.5

INVITES / USER

29%

ACCEPTANCE

Each user brings in one more. Rare.

WHAT WE DISPROVED

Enterprise salespeople want referrals → DISPROVED

Independent professionals want random intros → DISPROVED

Facebook groups would drive signups → DISPROVED (NO GEOGRAPHIC DENSITY)

→ We believe data, not opinions. **The data says Go.**

Sources: Referna growth dashboard (n=134, Jul 13, 2026) · YC growth thresholds (Paul Graham)

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PRODUCT 1

Three ways to meet. One destination: **your circle.**

The live product — every visual is a real screenshot (members blurred).

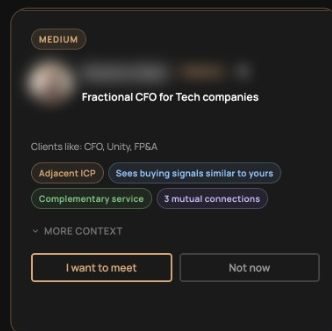
1 · APPLY

10-minute application

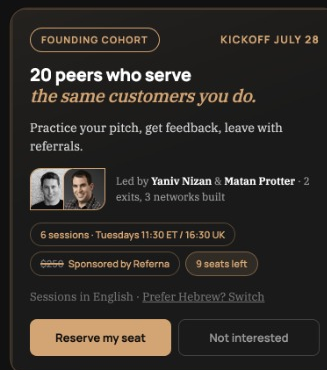
Who you serve, what a great referral looks like, calendar connect. Gordy builds your profile.



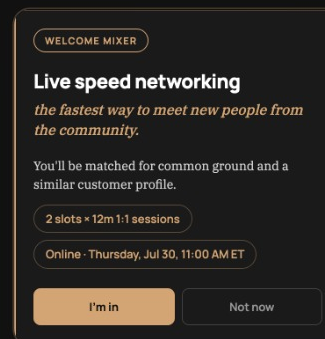
2 · MEET YOUR PEERS — THREE LANES



1:1 matches — mutual opt-in, Gordy books the call



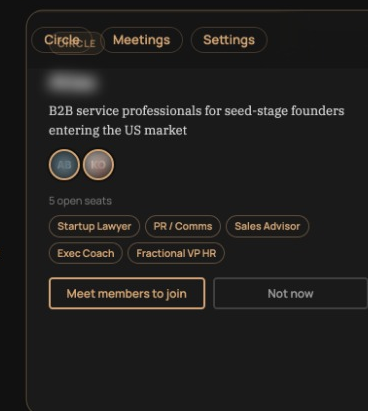
Cohort — six weekly founder-led sessions



Live mixer — speed networking, shipping now



3 · JOIN YOUR CIRCLE



8–12 peers who serve the same customer — and refer each other

→ Meeting the right peers is productized. **The circle turns meetings into consistent referrals.**

Sources: Referna app screenshots, production, July 2026 (member names blurred)

PRODUCT 2

Gordy replaces the chapter chairman and the membership committee.

BNI runs on ~40,000 human operators. Referna runs on one AI.

01 Onboards every member

Application, profile build, calendar connect — no human in the loop.

02 Recommends matches

By customer overlap and buying signals — not geography.

03 Schedules & runs the 1:1 intro calls

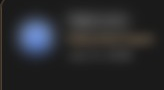
Finds the time across calendars, sets the agenda, joins the call, sends the recap.

04 Rewards contribution

Points for inviting, meeting, and referring — the behaviors that grow the network.

05 Keeps score so everyone benefits

Tracks give & take per member — the fairness a paid network must guarantee.



WHAT YOU COVERED

- ✓ **Backstory — how you started doing your own thing**
Ami shared his journey in marketing since 2009, transitioning to fractional CMO work for early-stage startups, while Yael discussed starting her independent HR consultancy after moving to London, leveraging her background in people operations.
- ✓ **A recent client — one you are proud of**
Ami spoke about helping Novi Security launch from stealth to raising \$51M and clarifying the website messaging for a company digitizing small-hold farming in Africa, while Yael mentioned assisting an Israeli startup in London with HR processes and finding success with 1:1 coaching.
- ✓ **How both fit on the same timeline of a single customer**
Ami's services fit for companies post-seed funding (around \$1M+) that need to scale marketing beyond initial networks, and Yael's services are for pre-seed to Series A startups needing HR functions or founders requiring coaching.
- ✓ **Test yourself - try to explain each other's buying moment**
Ami explained that Yael's clients often need HR support after raising funds and wanting to grow, or individuals seeking career coaching, while Yael described Ami's clients as post-seed startups needing to expand to new markets with an ineffective website.
- **What specific referral can you offer your peer**
No specific client referral was offered by either participant during the call.



A real Gordy-run 1:1, July 14 — note **"Test yourself"**

→ The operator role that caps every human network is now software.

Sources: Referna live-meeting agent, production call, July 2026 (names blurred) · BNI operator estimate: slide "Why Now"

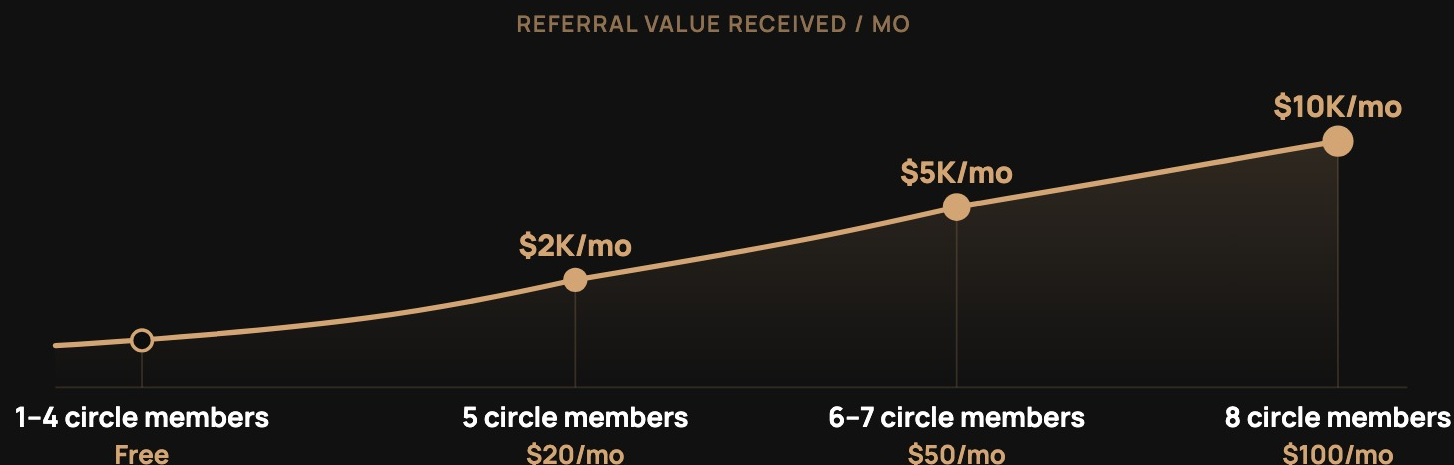
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BIZ MODEL

Referna makes money by charging a membership fee.

LOW FRICTION

Starts free

CAPTURES 1%
of value created

→ Proven business model that captures 1% of generated value with low friction.

Sources: Referna pricing schedule · monthly figures per member, illustrative (fee = 1% of referral value) · BNI, YPO, TAB also charge membership fees

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MARKET

21 segments. Startups segment first.

~130M independent professionals worldwide

4.41M in the US, across 10 segments

\$926B REFERRAL MARKET VOLUME
(math: ~\$100K per professional)



→ **9.26M** addressable but **starting where we'll grow fastest.**

Sources: US Census Bureau, BLS, LinkedIn (1.3B members, 2026), Referna market analysis

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TEAM

Two founders, two exits

3.5 years working together



Yaniv Nizan

Co-Founder & CEO

- CEO & co-founder of SOOMLA (acquired by ironSource/Unity)
- Built 3 networks — IntentClick (\$4M ARR ad network at Kontera), SOOMLA's payer-data network, SOOMLA's ad-creative network
- Customer in 4 referral-driven segments — startups, divorce, home-building, weddings



Matan Protter

Co-Founder & CTO

- CTO & co-founder of Infinity (acquired by Alibaba)
- 9 patents
- Talpiot graduate · PhD Technion
- 3.5 years shipping products with Yaniv — SynqUp and Referna



→ **Second startup together. 30+ combined years of building products.**

Sources: founder track records

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ROUND

Pre-seed for 24 months

12-month milestone: 4,000 Weekly Active Users

IT'S ACHIEVABLE

We've doubled every ~2 weeks since launch (77 WAU). 4K is just six more doublings — and the milestone gives us 12 months.

IT'S ENOUGH FOR SEED

- Network businesses raise seed at this scale (Clubhouse, Boardy, ...).
- 4,000 WAU → ~500 weekly referrals → ~\$130M annualized economic value.

WHAT WE NEED

Pre-seed · 24 months runway · Team of 4 (founders + 2 Talpiot graduates) · 12m buffer before seed.

Active = engaged with another user in the last 7 days

Referral = introduction at the moment of need (proof: the call)

→ 4,000 active is **seed-ready scale** for a network business — and we have the path.

Sources: Referna product data; segment sizing (slide 8)

Why this is a great opportunity

Proven model.

BNi runs the offline version at
\$26.4B/yr — 340K members.

Fast growth.

Doubling every 2 weeks.
77 WAU, 134 registered in 6 weeks.
Three invitation channels working.

Winning team.

Two post-exit founders.
Second startup together.
3.5 years of cohesion.

We're moving fast. Move with us.